March 2023

Ipsos UK's Annual Study of Young People 2023

Dear Parent / Guardian,

Ipsos UK, an independent research agency, is running the *Annual Study of Young People 2023*. With the co-operation of the Headteacher, your child's school has kindly agreed to take part in the research study. This will involve your child completing an online questionnaire during a single class period.

This national study is funded by public and voluntary sector organisations, including the educational charity **The Sutton Trust**, **The Department for Education, The Royal Meteorological Society,** which provides education programmes on weather and climate, and the government's gambling regulator, **The Gambling Commission.** The survey questionnaire asks young people across England, Scotland, and Wales about their opinions on a range of topics such as higher education, their understanding of climate change, gambling, and online behaviour. The findings from the study are used by these organisations to understand young people's experiences, and to better support and protect young people.

Ipsos UK can assure **complete confidentiality** of your child and their school. Your child will not be required to provide their name, and only **anonymous** data will be reported to the organisations mentioned above. The results will be presented in statistical reports including breakdowns by age, gender, and ethnicity in a way in which **no individual child or school can be identified**. Researchers will be able to look at the data, but they will not be able to identify which pupils have taken part in the study.

Your child's involvement in this project will help to ensure the survey produces a nationally representative sample, and I hope you have no objections to them taking part. If you do have any queries about how the survey will be run in class or would like to withdraw your child from taking part in this study, please contact their form tutor as soon as possible.

If you have any further queries or questions, please do not hesitate to contact Ipsos UK by e-mail at UK-PA-YPO2023@ipsos.com

Yours faithfully,

Jessica Ozan
Study Director, *Ipsos UK*

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*Please return this slip to the school as soon as possible if you do **NOT** want your child to take part.*

Child's name: ..... *Child's form/tutor group:* .....

Signature: ..... *Date:* .....

More information about the study

How are the data collected?

Data are collected through schools because research has shown that pupils give more honest answers about their experiences and opinions when they are surveyed in schools than other locations.

The study involves pupils completing an online questionnaire administered under 'examination conditions' and supervised by a teacher or non-teaching staff during one class or tutor period. Instructions about how to complete the online survey are provided to pupils. Pupils are also given leaflets with more information about the study, a privacy policy illustrating their rights, and sources of advice if they have any concerns.

What type of questions will be asked?

The survey covers a wide range of social issues including attitudes to gambling, online behaviours, the likelihood of attending university in the future, and experience of tuition. Alongside views on climate change and perception of their own wellbeing and resilience, and some questions about your child such as their gender and ethnicity. Pupils do not have to answer the questions about themselves and can choose 'prefer not to say' at every question. In order not to take up too much lesson time, not all questions will be asked of all pupils.

What happens if my child does not want to take part?

It will be made clear to all children when they are given the questionnaires that they do not have to answer any questions that they don't want to, and they do not have to take part at all if they don't want to. **Your child is free to stop taking part at any time, without giving a reason**.

How are the data used?

The survey findings are used by The Royal Meteorological Society, The Department for Education, The Sutton Trust and The Gambling Commission. These organisations use the findings to shape services and provide information for young people, and to help them make the right decisions about how to support and protect young people.

What happens to the data collected from the survey?

Ipsos UK will store participants' information securely and the name and address of your school and of the class group that takes part will not be passed on to any other organisation. Young people will not be required to provide their name on the online questionnaire.

Anonymous results from the survey will be reported to the organisations mentioned above, and some organisations choose to publish their findings. Pupils will not be identified in these reports and individual data will not be published.

Is confidentiality guaranteed?

Yes. Data will be used for research purposes only and in accordance with Market Research Society Code of Conduct and the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR).

If you have any questions, please contact Ipsos UK at UK-PA-YPO2023@ipsos.com or call our freephone number 08000149466.